Data Retention and Deletion Policy

Effective Date: March 7, 2026

1. Purpose

Define how long EduPulse retains data, how data is securely deleted/anonymized, and how data subject rights requests are processed.

2. Scope

This policy applies to student, parent/guardian, staff, proprietor, billing, security, and system operational data processed by EduPulse.

3. Retention Periods

- Student academic records: retained for duration of school contract + 5 years.
- Staff records: duration of contract + 3 years.
- Audit logs: 2 years minimum.
- Billing and payment records: 7 years (tax and accounting compliance).
- Authentication and security telemetry: 12 months minimum unless a legal hold applies.

4. Legal Basis for Extended Retention

Data may be retained beyond stated periods where required by:

- Applicable law or regulator direction.
- Ongoing investigations, litigation, or formal dispute resolution.
- Tax and financial reporting obligations.

5. Deletion and Anonymization Controls

- Records reaching end-of-retention are deleted on scheduled maintenance cycles.
- Where direct deletion is impractical, irreversible anonymization is applied.
- Backups are retained by backup schedule and expire automatically.
- Restoration testing must confirm expired data does not re-enter active systems outside policy.

6. DSAR (Data Subject Access Request) Workflow

6.1 Intake Channels

- Email to designated privacy contact.
- Controller-authorized request via official school admin contact.

6.2 Verification

- Identity and authority are verified before processing.
- Requests without sufficient identity proof are paused pending verification.

6.3 Response SLAs

- Acknowledgement: within 3 business days.
- Initial response/outcome: within 30 calendar days.
- Complex requests may be extended once (up to additional 30 days) with written reason.

6.4 Request Types Supported

- Access to personal data.
- Rectification/correction.
- Deletion/erasure (subject to legal obligations).
- Restriction/objection where legally applicable.
- Export/portability where feasible.

6.5 DSAR Evidence Record

For each request, maintain:

- Request ID and date received.
- Requestor identity verification status.
- Request type and affected data categories.
- Actions taken and completion date.
- Legal basis where request is denied or partially fulfilled.

7. Roles and Responsibilities

- Data Protection Lead: policy owner, DSAR oversight, regulator liaison.
- Engineering Lead: technical deletion/anonymization implementation and evidence.
- School Proprietor (Controller representative): request authorization and business approval.

8. Policy Review

- Review this policy at least annually, or after major legal/technical changes.
- Keep versioned records of approvals and changes.